Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht

Greek ὄπεας/ὄπεαρ 'awl'
Author(s): Brent Vine
Source: *Glotta*, 72. Bd., 1./4. H. (1994), pp. 31-40
Published by: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht (GmbH & Co. KG)
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/40266983
Accessed: 13-11-2015 12:36 UTC

Your use of the JSTOR archive indicates your acceptance of the Terms & Conditions of Use, available at http://www.jstor.org/page/info/about/policies/terms.jsp

JSTOR is a not-for-profit service that helps scholars, researchers, and students discover, use, and build upon a wide range of content in a trusted digital archive. We use information technology and tools to increase productivity and facilitate new forms of scholarship. For more information about JSTOR, please contact support@jstor.org.



Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht (GmbH & Co. KG) is collaborating with JSTOR to digitize, preserve and extend access to *Glotta*.

http://www.jstor.org

This content downloaded from 193.0.65.67 on Fri, 13 Nov 2015 12:36:48 UTC
All use subject to JSTOR Terms and Conditions

Greek *ὄπεας/ὄπεαρ* 'awl'

By Brent Vine, Los Angeles

Greek *ὄπεας* or *ὄπεαρ* 'awl' (with uncertain nom. sg.) has been interpreted (Schwyzer) as a substantivized adj. form **opā-u̯n̥t* (> **οπᾱ̃Ϝα* + secondary *-s* > nom. Att.-Ion. *ὄπεας*), i.e. the neuter of a **-u̯ent-* adj. based on *ὀπή* 'hole, opening' (thus [e.g. horn, bone] 'provided with an eyelet [or curved handle]'). This is rejected, for morphological and semantic reasons, in favor of an analysis **opā-u̯r̥/*opā-u̯n̥(t)-* (> nom. *ὄπεαρ*), i.e. a secondary *-u̯er/n-*stem (also based on *ὀπή*) meaning 'hole(-making) thing', of the type Hitt. *k(a)rāwar* 'horn(s)' (lit. 'horn(y) thing'). The analysis has implications for some of the usages of Myc. *opawota* (a word hitherto not connected with *ὄπεας/ὄπεαρ*), and for the sole attestation of the word for 'awl' in early Greek prose (Hdt. 4.70).

1. The Ancient Greek word for 'awl' is lemmatized in the form nom. sg. *ὄπεας* (e.g. LSJ, Chantraine, Frisk, Boisacq [s.v. *ὀπή*]). The word was replaced relatively early by diminutive forms *ὀπήτιον, ὀπητίδιον* (Hippoc., LXX, etc.), while attestations of *ὄπεας* itself appear limited to the following:

(i) Nicochares (Kock 9 = Kassel–Austin 12) *ὄπεαρ* and †*ὄπερ*† (Kock *ὄπεαρ*), cited (with v.l. *ὄπεας* [for *ὄπεαρ*] and *ὀπήτιον*) Poll. 7.83 and 10.141 (see below)

(ii) Hdt. 4.70 *ὑπέατι*

(iii) Hippon fr. 78.6: West [*ὑ*]*πέατι*, Masson [*ὀ/ὑ*]*πέατι*[1])

(iv) Hsch. *ὑπέατα· ὀπήτια*[2])

An actual nominative singular form is attested only three times, in the two passages of Pollux preserving the Nicochares fragment. As it happens, both passages present textual difficulties with respect to this form. At 10.141, introducing the comic fragment, the text of Pollux reads ... *καὶ χηλεύματα καὶ ὄπεαρ καὶ ὀπήτιον εἴρηται ἐν Νικοχάρους Κρησίν,*

τοῖς τρυπάνοις ἀντίπαλον †*ὄπερ ἀρχίλιον*†

with variae lectiones *ὄπεας* (for *ὄπεαρ*) and *ἀγχίλιον* (for the corrupt *ἀρχίλιον*). For the fragment, Kock's conjecture *ὄπεαρ χιλίοις* (partly inspired by Bentley's *ὄπεας χίλιον*) depends not only on his plausible

---

[1]) See on this passage Miralles 1983: 7 f., with comments on the meaning of the word in context (perhaps not awl, but "un robusto ago").

[2]) Schmidt's reconstruction of the transmitted text *ὖπεα· τὰ ὀπίσθια.*

Glotta LXXII, 31–40, ISSN 0017-1298
© Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht 1995

This content downloaded from 193.0.65.67 on Fri, 13 Nov 2015 12:36:48 UTC
All use subject to JSTOR Terms and Conditions

interpretation of the line ("laudat sutor subulam", easily paralleled in Old Comedy), but also on Poll. 7.83: here Pollux refers to (but does not quote) the same fragment, with the words *τὰ δὲ ὀπήτια ὅπερ ἐν Κρησί Νικοχάρης ἐκάλει*, the nonsensical *ὅπερ* being simply omitted in some manuscripts. There seems little doubt that Kock was correct in asserting "scribendum erit *ὄπεαρ*" for this passage, and his conjectured nom. sg. *ὄπεαρ* for the Nicochares fragment is likewise extremely attractive. The variant *ὄπεας* may nonetheless preserve a competing nom. sg. form.

2. Also problematic is the word-initial alternation *ὀπ-/ὑπ-*. In general, however, the *ὑπ-* seen in Herodotus and in the Hesychian gloss (the Hipponax fragment, from a papyrus, is indeterminate) is taken, probably correctly, to be a secondary development (perhaps Ionic only) from *ὀπ-*, whether by sound change (cf. *ἀπό* vs. Myc. *a-pu-*, Arc. *ἄπυ* etc.),[3]) or via a folk-etymological association with *ὑπό*, or a combination of these factors. Otherwise, it would be difficult to explain the initial *ὀπ-* not only of the *ὄπεας/ὄπεαρ* in Pollux/Nicochares, but also of the better-attested diminutives *ὀπήτιον* and *ὀπητίδιον*. Moreover, it is surely attractive to relate the word etymologically to the far more common word *ὀπή* 'hole, opening', as is normally assumed; this word, in turn, is generally (if somewhat tentatively) connected with *ὀπ-* 'eye' (< **h₃ekʷ-*), more on which below.

3. The best account of *ὄπεας* so far is that of Schwyzer (1933; cited with apparent approval by Frisk): according to Schwyzer, *ὄπεας* derives ultimately from *ὀπή* 'hole, opening' (cf. § 2), to which the possessive adjective-forming suffix **-u̯ent-* has been added, in its weak stem-form **-u̯n̥t-* (cf. Skt. *-vant-/-vat-*).[4]) This formation results in a pre-Gk. adj. (neut.) **opā-u̯at-*, which would have to mean 'provided with an *ὀπή*'. An 'awl' can only mean 'provided with a hole/opening' if the hole or opening refers to some feature of the tool itself: either an 'eyelet' (through which thread or a thong is passed), or a 'curved handle', these being the two possible senses of **opā-* (*ὀπή*) which Schwyzer's morphological analysis forces him to as-

[3]) Thus tentatively Hoffmann 1898: 288.

[4]) See Schwyzer for a convincing rejection, mainly on textual grounds, of Johannes Schmidt's earlier attempt to analyze Pollux's *ὄπεας* as an acc. pl. *ὀπέας* of a noun **ὀπεύς* 'der oder das *ὀπή* bewirkende' (although this would be semantically attractive).

This content downloaded from 193.0.65.67 on Fri, 13 Nov 2015 12:36:48 UTC
All use subject to JSTOR Terms and Conditions

sume.[5]) As for the development of a noun ὄπεας from the original adjective: Schwyzer takes this to have arisen from (neut.) noun + adj. phrases like (nom. sg.) *[κέρας] ὀπᾱϝα (ὀπᾱϝα < neut. nom./acc. sg. *opā-mat) 'curved-handled [or eyeleted] horn' or *[ὀστέον] ὀπᾱϝα 'curved-handled [or eyeleted] bone'; *ὀπᾱϝα then secondarily develops a final -s (perhaps after an associated nominative like κέρας), and then comes to be used on its own. The further phonological development of *ὀπᾱϝας needed to account for Ion. ὀπεᾱτ- (with nom. ὄπεας and contracted ὀπητ-) is entirely regular.

4. To consider this analysis point by point:

4.1 Can ὄπεας really mean what Schwyzer wants it to mean ('mit einer ὀπή Versehenes')? The real problem is not the relative naturalness (or, as it seems to me, unnaturalness) of the semantic developments Schwyzer envisions, or whether ancient awls had eyelets or curved handles, but whether ὀπή can mean any such thing. Unfortunately, this is far from clear: as is evident, for example, from the survey of attestations in LSJ, ὀπή refers to actual holes (such as holes in the ground, or rents in a garment), or to fairly substantial openings created in a building (such as a hole in a roof serving as a chimney), or (much more rarely) to bodily orifices. Only with the greatest difficulty can the word refer to the "opening" formed by the curvature of a handle, which is the meaning Schwyzer seems to favor. It is for this reason that Chantraine (DELG s. v.) expressed doubt as to Schwyzer's account of ὄπεας, although Chantraine concluded nevertheless that ὀπή is somehow still at the bottom of the word. Admittedly, it does seem possible for ὀπή to refer to an 'eyelet'; but the use of the word to refer to holes in fabric (as at Aristoph. *Pl.* 715, one of the earliest attestations), not to mention the primary function of awls, certainly make it desirable to find a morphological account according to which the 'opening' refers to the tool's result (and not some feature of its appearance or construction), as in Johannes Schmidt's earlier conception (which nevertheless had to be rejected on other grounds, cf. n. 4).

4.2 As for the presumed substantivization of a *-ment- adjective: despite the frequency of such adjectives in Greek, this happens very rarely, and under restricted circumstances.[6]) All known examples fall

---

[5]) Schwyzer was in fact able to cite archaeological reports showing that at least some ancient Mediterranean awls could well have had curved handles.

[6]) The actually-attested *-ment- adj. based on ὀπή, i.e. ὀπήεις, did not undergo substantivization (δίφρος ὀπήεις = 'obstetric chair', Hippoc. *Mul.* 2.114).

This content downloaded from 193.0.65.67 on Fri, 13 Nov 2015 12:36:48 UTC
All use subject to JSTOR Terms and Conditions

into two classes, i.e. a small group of (mainly) food terms and (occasionally) plant names found in Attic prose (see on these Chantraine [1933: 272]: *σησαμοῦς* 'sesame cake', *τυροῦς* 'cheese cake', etc.), and toponyms; the former all have the form **-o-u̯ent-*, and the latter show the same in alphabetic Greek (e.g. *Σελῑνοῦς*, Meg. *Σελῑνοεντι*), replacing earlier **-o-u̯ont-* (Myc. *se-ri-no-wo-te*; cf. Lejeune 1969 and n.9 below). The only actual noun in **-ā-u̯ent-* seems to be *ἀλλᾶς, -ᾶντος* '(garlic) sausage' (**ἀλλᾱ-ϝεντ-*); but the "W. Gk." nominal basis **ἄλλᾱ* has been borrowed from the word for 'garlic' that appears in Italic (cf. Lat. *ālium/allum*, and esp. *ἄλλην· λάχανον. Ἰταλοί* Hsch.), again a food term/plant name (cf. *σησαμοῦς* et al.). The nature of this material provides little support for the process Schwyzer envisions, even if – or perhaps especially if – the adjective formation **-eh₂-u̯ent-* itself may be quite old.[7]) Nevertheless, it remains marginally possible that such a substantivization could have occurred; thus the facts adduced here should be taken as disquieting objections, rather than decisive counterevidence.

4.3 More disturbing is the import of Mycenaean data (of course unknown to Schwyzer) for the morphological analysis itself. Recall that Schwyzer's adjective **ὀπᾱ-ϝατ-* must have zero grade of the **-u̯ent-* suffix; nevertheless, certain well-known facts raise severe difficulties for such a form: the zero-grade allomorph **-u̯n̥t-* should result in Myc. */-u̯at-/* or (more likely, given the labial environment) */-u̯ot-/*, but this has already been replaced by */-u̯et-/* after *e*-grade **-u̯ent-*, as in fem. *-we-sa*, abundantly attested.[8]) Nor is any other trace of zero grade attested in the inflection of *-(ϝ)εντ-* adjectives, cf. masc. gen. sg. *-(ϝ)εντ-ος* for **-(ϝ)ατ-ος* (cf. Skt. *-vat-as* < **-u̯n̥t-os*). The only survival of zero-grade **-u̯n̥t-* appears in toponymic adjectives of the type *Φλειάσιος* (to *Φλειοῦς*, gen. *Φλειοῦντος*).[9]) Thus

---

[7]) On Hom. *-ήεις*, Ved. *-āvant-*, Hitt. *-aḫ(ḫu)want-* see Watkins 1975: 13 n.3, 15 n.8 (= 1994: 522 n.3, 524 n.8), with reference to Eichner 1973: 57ff.

[8]) On this process (with reanalysis of some of the Myc. material) see recently Meier-Brügger 1989: 208f.; on Myc. spellings *-wo-tV* cf. also the next footnote.

[9]) Schwyzer 1939: 527 n.4, cf. Meier-Brügger 1989: 209 n.7 and esp. Heubeck 1976, who convincingly defends this interpretation of *-ασιος* (together with possible Mycenaean comparanda: *wo-no-wa-ti-si, ti-nwa-si-jo*); note also the new example Arc. *Ελισϝασιο-* (te Riele 1987: 171f.), with toponym basis *Ελισ(ϝ)οντ-* (on the absence of digamma in the spelling of the toponym [judged problematic by te Riele, 1987: 172 with n.15] see now Peters 1993: 390 n.30). For the toponyms themselves, esp. Myc. *-wo-tV* as */-u̯ont-/* < **-u̯ont-* (not */-u̯ot-/* < **-u̯n̥t-*), see again Lejeune 1969 and Heubeck 1976.

This content downloaded from 193.0.65.67 on Fri, 13 Nov 2015 12:36:48 UTC
All use subject to JSTOR Terms and Conditions

ὄπεας, in Schwyzer's account, would preserve a morphologically antediluvian relic-form that would have escaped what otherwise seems to be one of the oldest innovations of Proto-Greek. Such relics do indeed surface, on occasion, in isolated forms (as probably in the type Φλειάσιος [NB: onomastic, and extra-paradigmatic, i.e. an isolated formation derivationally related to *-*u̯ent-* adjectives, not a *-*u̯ent-* adj. as such]); but this would be harder to admit in the present case, in which the form in question was allegedly embedded in a noun phrase containing what is supposed to be an otherwise ordinary *-*u̯ent-* adjective as part of the starting point. Indeed, Schwyzer's later reference to his earlier work is more tentative, precisely on this point: in the context of the general replacement of expected *-*Fατ-* (from zero-grade *-*u̯n̥t-*) by *-Fετ-* after *-Fεντ-*, he remarks (1939: 527 n. 4), after citing Φλειάσιος: "unsicherer *ὀπᾶFατ- in ὄπεας (ὄπεαρ) usw. (Schwyzer, KZ 60, 224 ff.)".

4.4 From the point of view of morphology, the probable existence of a nom. sg. ὄπεαρ, beside or instead of ὄπεας, raises an additional problem. (Schwyzer's choice to entitle his paper "Griech. ὀπεατ- ...", and not "Griech. ὄπεας ...", was clearly a considered one.) Although Schwyzer has little to say on this point, a nom. ὄπεαρ, according to his analysis, would have to be taken as secondary. But a neuter noun ὄπεαρ, belonging to an unproductive type, is not easy to motivate secondarily.[10])

5. In view of the above problems, it may be worthwhile to propose the following alternative account of this word, which begins from A. Nussbaum's analysis (1986: 31 ff., building on Eichner 1973: 92 n. 35) of the small class of Hittite words *k(a)rāwar* 'horn(s)', *partăwar* 'wing', *ašawar* '(livestock) pen', *ḫaršawar* 'agriculture'. These words show secondary *-*u̯er/n-*stems (cf. loc. *ga-ra-u-ni*[-, instr. *pár-ta-a-u-ni-it* etc.) based on abstracts in *-ā* (< *-*eh*$_2$); the neuters characterized by this suffixation (a derivational process that would have occurred within Hittite, to judge from the laryngeal loss), can be thought of as concretized abstracts (a common development: *toga* '[abstr.] covering' > (actual) 'cover(ing)' etc.), according to Nussbaum's plausible semantic analysis. Thus the presumed abstract

[10]) Cf. again Schwyzer's later comment (1939: 519 n. 7), with reference to Hom. πεῖραρ vs. Pi. πεῖρας, Att. πέρας: "Umgekehrt ὄπεαρ für ὄπεας?". See now also Luppe 1993 on the possible δέ]λεας (= δέλεαρ 'bait') in Stesich. fr. 35.15 (P. Oxy. 3876).

This content downloaded from 193.0.65.67 on Fri, 13 Nov 2015 12:36:48 UTC
All use subject to JSTOR Terms and Conditions

(Hitt.) **k(e)rā-* (cf. also Myc. *ke-ra, ke-ra-ja-pi*, 1986: 36 ff.) would have meant 'horn' (the material), as opposed to *krāwar* '(the) horn(y) thing', i.e. 'horns (of an animal)'; similarly *aš-* 'remain' > abstract **ašā-*, concretized as *ašawar* 'thing (i.e. place) for remaining', i.e. '(livestock) pen', etc. (see Nussbaum for various details concerning the semantic analysis of the individual forms). Applying this schema to *ὀπή*, and using, for the time being, an informal (and possibly anachronistic) reconstruction **opā-* (if the connection with **h₃ekʷ-* is correct [cf. § **2** above], more on which below, § **6.4**), we arrive at an identically-formed **opā-u̯r̥/*opā-u̯n̥(t)-* 'hole/opening thing' (> 'awl'), whence regularly Ion. *ὄπεαρ/ὀπεᾱτ-* (contracted *ὀπητ-*). In semantic terms, the derivation is straightforward, and clearly more appealing than Schwyzer's 'something provided with a "hole"'. Note also that in formal terms, this analysis produces not *ὄπεας*, but *ὄπεαρ*, which is potentially attractive, given the evidence favoring nom. *ὄπεαρ* (§ **1**) and the difficulty of explaining *ὄπεαρ* secondarily (cf. § **4.4** above). The language shows a clear spread of *-ας* at the expense of older neuters, in certain semantic fields, and this is particularly well-represented in some key words related to leatherworking: thus Hom. *κῶας* 'fleece' for earlier **κῶος* (cf. Myc. *ko-wo*, Hom. *κώεα, κώεσι*), and *δέρος* 'hide' (trag. +), partly replaced by *δέρας*.[11]) Thus, in the event that a nom. sg. *ὄπεας* actually existed (cf. § **1**), there are reasonable possibilities for explaining such a form on the basis of an original *ὄπεαρ*.

One might object that such a secondary neuter **-u̯er/n-* formation is otherwise unknown in Greek. But such a construct is formally unexceptionable: compare the intriguingly similar Hom. *ὀπᾱ́(ϝ)ων* 'companion', which (according to the usual analysis) is a secondary (animate) *u̯on*-stem, based on an *ā*-stem **ὀπᾱ́-* (< [Pr.-Gk.] **hokʷā-*), though of course etymologically distinct from the **ὀπᾱ-* of **ὀπᾱ-ϝαρ* > *ὄπεαρ*, according to the above proposal. If, moreover, both Greek and Hittite show traces of the same moribund derivational process, this might suggest certain possibilities for the Indo-European status of the formation, although the basis for such speculations remains too slender to be pursued at present.

---

[11]) See Nussbaum (1986: 151) on this process, with the additional example *-πελας* 'skin' (in *ἐρυσίπελας* 'inflammation of the skin'), cf. *πέλμα* 'sole' and *δέρμα/δέρας*.

This content downloaded from 193.0.65.67 on Fri, 13 Nov 2015 12:36:48 UTC
All use subject to JSTOR Terms and Conditions

6. The above interpretation of *ὄπεαρ* may be of interest in connection with certain facts from Mycenaean.

6.1 Using the informal notation as above, the predicted outcome of a neut. nom./acc. pl. **opā-u̯n̥t-a* in Mycenaean would be */opāu̯ota/*, spelled *o-pa-wo-ta*. As it happens, such a form is actually attested (as well as its abbreviation "O") in armory tablets from both Knossos and Pylos, although it is interpreted in an entirely different way (see Aura Jorro 1993: 32, s.v.). It is said to spell a word */op-au̯orta/*, meaning 'things (plates?) hung onto' (certain types of armor), i.e. *opi-* + a verbal advjective based on *ἀείρω* 'lift, hang' (cf. **h₂u̯(e)rt-* probably also in *ἀρτάω* 'fasten, tie onto').

6.2 The 'real world' interpretation of these *opawota*, however, is rather unclear (see the discussion and extensive references in Aura Jorro, loc. cit.). This problem, in turn, is related to a textual fact about Myc. *opawota* that seems to me insufficiently appreciated, namely that there may be two quite different types: one connected with corslets or cuirasses and similar chest armor (and perhaps, as an "unmarked" term, other protective devices for body surface areas: greaves, armguards, etc.), and another connected with helmets. Indeed, whereas Mycenologists and Aegean archaeologists have felt more or less comfortable with the idea of some form of 'affixed' (*/op-au̯ort-/*) padding or plates in the context of chest gear,[12]) the situation with helmets is rather different: here a great variety of actual referents has been proposed, often with notable vagueness: "strisce o lamine aderenti alla calotta dell'elmo" (Càssola, following Snodgrass), neck-protecting plates attached to a helmet (Marinatos), "parte superiore dell'elmo" (Doria), something like the Homeric *τρυφάλεια* (Borchard), etc. (see Aura Jorro for references). Consider the following Pylos text with *opawota* (PY Sh 737; similarly most of the other texts in the Sh series):

CORSLET 1 *o-pa-wo-ta, me-zo-a₂*, O 20 *me-u-jo-a₂*, O 10
ko-ru-to, O 4 *pa-ra-wa-jo* 2

To provide a standard translation (Docs.² p. 379, no. 293): "One corslet: 20 larger-sized *plates*, ten smaller-sized *plates*, four *plates* of the helmet, two cheek-pieces". Note, first of all, that the "corslet *opawota*" come in two varieties, "larger" and "smaller"; this distinction never appears with "helmet *opawota*". Perhaps it is judged to be ob-

---

[12]) Although not with unanimity: the cuirass *opawota* are "evidently metallic belts" according to N. Verdelis (apud Åström 1977: 43, a discussion not cited in Aura Jorro's survey).

This content downloaded from 193.0.65.67 on Fri, 13 Nov 2015 12:36:48 UTC
All use subject to JSTOR Terms and Conditions

vious that these would be the "smaller" variety; nevertheless, it is noteworthy that the helmet *opawota* are specified as such, in this case with a genitive singular */koruthos/* (thus also Sh 733, 740, 741, 742, 743, 744; otherwise abbreviated "*KO* O 4", Sh 734, 735, 738, 739).

6.3 The Knossos texts (Sk series) are particularly interesting in this regard. In the two cases with sufficient context (Sk 5670.2 and 9195.2 are fragmentary), the "helmet *opawota*" are again specified as such (here with an accompanying adjective *opikorusija*), *even though the immediately preceding text heading clearly indicates HELMET as the general reference*; thus in Sk 8100, the heading *ko-ru* HELMET 1 is followed directly by *o-pi-ko-ru-si-ja o-pa-wo-ta* 4[13]) (similarly Sk 8149), cf. PY "*ko-ru-to* O 4" and "*KO* O 4" above. It seems possible, then, that there are two quite distinct types of *opawota*: one, the corslet type, is "unmarked" (although it comes in larger and smaller sizes), and the second is specified as "helmet *opawota*", even if the context already refers clearly to helmets. We might therefore have two homographs, i.e.:

o-pa-wo-ta[1] (chest-plates et sim., larger and smaller sizes)
o-pa-wo-ta[2] (PY *ko-ru-to* O, *KO* O = KN *o-pi-ko-ru-si-ja o-pa-wo-ta*)

These are differentiated in the texts, perhaps by scribal convention, via the apparently obligatory adjectival or genitive marking for the second type. In view of the spiky (and generally curved) protrusions on some types of Minoan and Mycenaean helmets, often paired (as in the common "corna bovine" type),[14]) or in a group of four,[15]) I suggest (very tentatively) that *o-pa-wo-ta*[2] (i.e. the "helmet *opawota*") may mean something like "helmet spikes", continuing the same word as alphabetic Greek ὄπεαρ (originally 'hole[-making] thing, poker'), in the predictable second-millenium form */opāu̯ota/* (as distinct from *o-pa-wo-ta*[1] = */opau̯orta/*, as above, for the chest-protecting plates or pads).

6.4 Note finally that if this suggestion is correct, the traditional derivation of ὀπή (and therefore also ὄπεαρ) from *h₃ek̑u̯-* 'eye' (cf. §§ **2, 5** above) would have to be abandoned, since the labiovelar would

---

[13]) Here actually *o-pa-wo-ta* 2 written superscript, above *o-pi-ko-ru-si-ja* 2 (similarly Sk 8149); for the interpretation "*opikorusija opawota* 4", see Docs.[2] p.524 and KT[5] p.310 ad Sk 8100.

[14]) See e.g. Càssola 1973: 101 with Tav. XXXI, 1.

[15]) See e.g. Docs.[2] p.377, Fig.26, F (cf. also G ["corna bovine" type], and D, H [ram's horn type]).

This content downloaded from 193.0.65.67 on Fri, 13 Nov 2015 12:36:48 UTC
All use subject to JSTOR Terms and Conditions

be preserved in Mycenaean. (A plausible alternative root etymology [< **sep-*? *h₃ep-*? etc.] has thus far not suggested itself.)

7. I conclude with a comment on the Herodotus passage cited at the outset (§ 1 (ii)), which provides our earliest prose attestation of the word. The context is explicitly martial: Herodotus describes the warlike Scythians' oath-taking ritual, which involves drinking wine and blood, and in which weapons figure prominently. The blood is drawn, according to Herodotus, by pricking the skin either with a *μάχαιρα* (a military dagger or short sword) or "*ὑπέατι*" – with an 'awl', according to the usual interpretation; in de Sélincourt's classic translation:

> ... they fill a large earthenware bowl with wine and drop into it a little of the blood of the two parties to the oath, having drawn it either by a prick with an *awl* or a slight cut with a *knife*; then they dip into the bowl a *sword*, some *arrows*, a *battle-axe*, and a *javelin*, and speak a number of prayers; lastly, the two contracting parties and the chief followers drink the mixture of wine and blood.

A handy leatherworking tool amongst all this weaponry seems a bit out of place. Perhaps, then, Herodotus (or more likely his source) preserves in this *ὑπέατι* a last trace of a military sense (roughly 'spike', 'lance' vel sim.) similar to that conjectured above for Myc. "*o-pa-wo-ta*^{2}".[16])

Bibliography

Åström, P. 1977. The Cuirass Tomb and Other Finds at Dendra, Pt. I: The Chamber Tombs. Göteborg.
Aura Jorro, F., 1993. Diccionario micénico. II. Madrid.
Boisacq, E. B., Dictionnaire étymologique de la langue grecque. (Repr.) Paris 1938.
Càssola Guida, P. 1973. Le armi difensive dei Micenei nelle figurazioni. Rome.
Chantraine, P. 1933. La formation des noms en grec ancien. Paris.
Chantraine (DELG), P. C. Dictionnaire étymologique de la langue grecque: Histoire des mots. Paris 1968–1980.
Doc.^{2}: M. Ventris and J. Chadwick, Documents in Mycenaean Greek (2nd ed.). Cambridge 1973.
Eichner, H. 1973. Die Etymologie von heth. *meḫur*. *MSS* 31, 53–107.
Frisk (GEW), H. F., Griechisches etymologisches Wörterbuch. Heidelberg 1960–1972.

---

[16]) An earlier version of this paper was presented at the 13th East Coast Indo-European Conference (Austin, Texas; May 1994); I am grateful to the participants for their helpful comments, and to Mr. Robert Cro (of the Department of Archaeology, Princeton University) for his help with the archaeological material.

This content downloaded from 193.0.65.67 on Fri, 13 Nov 2015 12:36:48 UTC
All use subject to JSTOR Terms and Conditions

Heubeck, A. 1976. Epikritisches zu den griechischen Ortsnamen mit dem *-went-/-wont-*Suffix, besonders zu dem Namen *Phleius*. *SMEA* 17, 127–136.
Hoffmann, O. 1898. Die griechischen Dialekte, 3. Band (Der ionische Dialekt). Göttingen.
KT[5]: J. Killen and J.-P. Olivier. The Knossos Tablets (5th ed.). Salamanca 1989 (= *Minos* suppl. 11).
Lejeune, M. 1969. Sur les toponymes mycéniens en *-wont-*. BSL 64, 43–56.
LSJ: H. Liddell and R. Scott, A Greek-English Lexicon, new ed. by H. Jones and R. McKenzie. Oxford 1925–1968.
Luppe, W. 1993. *δέλεας = δέλεαρ*. *Glotta* 71, 36–37.
Meier-Brügger, M. 1989. Episch *μητίετα* (*Ζεύς*) und das Suffix *-(ϝ)εντ-*. *HS* 102, 207–210.
Miralles, C. 1983. Il fr. 78 W. di Ipponatte. *QUCC* 43 [n. s. 14], 7–16.
Nussbaum, A. 1986. Head and Horn in: indo-European. Berlin – New York.
Peters, M. 1993. Ein weiterer Fall für das Rixsche Gesetz, in: Indogermanica et Italica: Festschrift für Helmut Rix zum 65. Geburtstag (ed. G. Meiser, IBS 72), 373–405.
te Riele, G.-J.-M.-J. 1987. Hélisson entre en sympolitie avec Mantinée: une nouvelle inscription d'Arcadie. *BCH* 111, 167–190.
Schwyzer, E. 1933. Griech. *ὀπεατ-* und andere Bezeichnungen der Ahle. *KZ* 60, 224–232.
Schwyzer, E. 1939 [1953[2]]. Griechische Grammatik, I. Band. München.
Watkins, C. 1975. La famille indo-européenne de grec *ὄρχις*: linguistique, poétique, et mythologie. *BSL* 70, 11–26; reprinted in C. W., *Selected Writings*, vol. II (ed. L. Oliver, Innsbruck 1994), 520–535.

This content downloaded from 193.0.65.67 on Fri, 13 Nov 2015 12:36:48 UTC
All use subject to JSTOR Terms and Conditions